



CAPEX MANTRA

Nitin Gadkari, Minister of Road Transport & Highways

» Speaking at the India Today-Business Today Budget Round Table 2025, the minister said there is no shortage of money for highways projects

» He said there had been efforts to get the private sector players, making them the drivers in this sector

» He also said the new toll policy, which is to be unveiled soon, will bring relief to travellers



INVESTMENT, INDUSTRY, IMPACT

Piyush Goyal, Minister of Commerce and Industry

» Speaking on US President Trump's policies, Goyal said it is too early to be concerned

» On the depreciation of the rupee, he said that while many currencies have seen sharp declines, the rupee's depreciation has been relatively modest

» Speaking about the increase in tax exemption limit, Maddirala said, "We are likely to get a bump of ₹40,000-₹45,000 crore in deposits, which will help banks in lending"

» DEA Secretary Seth said rather than promoting specific savings instruments, the government believes in empowering individuals to make their own choices

» Speaking on disinvestment, Chawla said the government is adopting a composite strategy to ensure that the value of public assets is optimised and shared with people

» Agarwal said the rationalisation of GST rates continues to be a priority. "Now the Weighted Average Rate of GST is only 11%," he said

THE BUDGET MAKERS

(From left) **Nagaraju Maddirala**, Secretary, Department of Financial Services

Sanjay Kumar Agarwal Chairman, Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs

Ajay Seth Secretary, Department of Economic Affairs

Arunish Chawla Secretary, DIPAM & Department of Public Enterprises

